

● EASY

● INFORMATION AND IDEAS

● ANSWER KEY

Information and Ideas

02

10 answers · Rationale-rich · Teach from doc

Q1**D**

D. evolved to have underground traps to access more prey than would surface traps.

Choice D is the best answer. The text says that *N.pudica*'s prey-catching pitchers are underground. It also says that the ridges where *N. pudica* lives don't have many plants and animals on the surface. This suggests that *N. pudica* evolved underground pitchers in order to catch more prey.

Choice A is incorrect. This inference isn't supported. The text never mentions the possibility of other undiscovered carnivorous plant species in Indonesia, so there's no basis to make this inference. Choice B is incorrect. This inference isn't supported. The text does say that the ridges where *N. pudica* lives are dry, but it also says that the purpose of carnivorous plant pitchers is to capture prey. It never suggests that these pitchers also absorb moisture, so there's no basis to make this inference. Choice C is incorrect. This inference isn't supported. The text never suggests that *N. pudica*'s underground pitcher can catch animals on the surface, so there's no basis to make this inference.

Q2

A

A. Some of the newer pits were carved on top of the older pits.

Choice A is the best answer because it presents a statement about Veronica Waweru's thinking that is supported by the text. The text begins by discussing Waweru's discovery of evidence that ancient versions of the board game mancala had been played at a site in the Lewa Wildlife Conservancy. The evidence consisted of many rows of shallow pits carved into stone. The text goes on to state that some newer pits were carved on top of older pits, suggesting that people may have continued to play the game there over multiple generations, creating new pits over time. The text then explicitly states that the presence of newer pits carved on top of older pits was precisely what caused Waweru to think that mancala had been played at the site for a long time.

Choice B is incorrect. While the text does state that Waweru "noticed many rows of shallow pits carved into stone," this observation led her to believe that the pits could have been used as game boards for ancient versions of mancala but did not specifically suggest to her that the game had been played at the site for a long time. The multiple rows of pits merely suggest that these pits functioned as part of a game board; they don't necessarily indicate how long the site had been used for that purpose. Rather, it was the fact that there appeared to be newer pits carved on top of older pits that led Waweru to think that mancala had been played at the site for a long time. Choice C is incorrect. Although the text states that Waweru found the pits at the Lewa Wildlife Conservancy, this isn't the reason the text gives for why she thought that mancala had been played at the site for a long time. The location of the discovery only provides information about where the game was played, not how long the game had been played there. Choice D is incorrect because the text doesn't mention any variation in the depth of the pits. The text only describes the pits collectively as shallow and doesn't indicate that the depth of the pits factored into Waweru's thinking about how long the site had been used for playing mancala.

Q3

B

- B. Participants who were provided with a ranking of the museums spent disproportionately more time reading about the British museum.
-

Choice B is the best answer. By looking at the top-ranked option, we can see that people provided with ranked lists spent more time reading about the British Museum than reading about other museums (36% of the time versus 21% for the second-ranked option).

Choice A is incorrect. The claim is about people with ranked lists, and these data are about those with unranked lists. Choice C is incorrect. The claim is about people with ranked lists looking at the top-ranked option, and these data are about the third-ranked option. Choice D is incorrect. The claim is about people with ranked lists, and these data are about those with unranked lists.

Q4

D

- D. *Hadestown* improved greatly between 2016 and its premiere on Broadway.
-

Choice D is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of critic Jesse Green's review of the 2016 and 2019 productions of *Hadestown*. The text states that Green found the storytelling in the 2016 off-Broadway version to be "very confusing" but that he "enthusiastically praised" the storytelling in the revised 2019 Broadway version. This stark contrast in Green's opinions suggests that he believed the musical had significantly improved between 2016 and its 2019 Broadway premiere.

Choice A is incorrect because it contradicts the information in the text. The text indicates that Green found the storytelling in the 2016 version to be "very confusing," while he "enthusiastically praised" the storytelling in the 2019 version. This suggests that the 2019 version had fewer, not more, storytelling problems. Choice B is incorrect because the text doesn't provide any information about Green's opinion on the size of the 2019 Broadway production. While it mentions that the 2019 production was larger than the 2016 production, there's no indication in the text that Green thought the 2019 production should have been even larger than it was. Choice C is incorrect because it contradicts the information in the text. The text's description of Green's enthusiastic praise for the 2019 production suggests that he found this version more enjoyable, not less enjoyable, than the 2016 version, which he described as "very confusing."

Q5

D

D. She altered classic songs by slowing them down.

Choice D is the best answer because it accurately describes an aspect of Chavela Vargas that the text indicates is unusual among ranchera artists. According to the text, Vargas differed from other ranchera singers by slowing the tempo of classic songs, which allowed her to express the emotional quality of the lyrics more fully.

Choice A is incorrect because the text states that Vargas possessed an unusually raspy voice for a ranchera singer, not a clear and polished voice. Choice B is incorrect because the text indicates that Vargas was known to perform songs written from a male point of view, not that she avoided such songs. Choice C is incorrect because nothing in the text suggests that Vargas disliked performing classic songs. Rather, it suggests that she found innovative ways of performing them to emphasize their emotional content, which seems to suggest an affinity for such songs, not dislike.

Q6

D

D. “Everything in the room was quiet, so quiet that the only thing to be heard was the rustling of the pages he turned.”

Choice D is the best answer because this quotation most effectively illustrates the claim that the author emphasizes the near silence of the setting where the character Valia is reading. In the quotation, the author highlights the near silence of the setting by twice using the word “quiet” to describe the room. The author also calls attention to the fact that Valia is reading in a nearly silent setting by noting that the only sound to be heard is that of the pages being turned.

Choice A is incorrect because this quotation suggests that Valia is in a chilly setting that causes his hand to become cold, not that he’s in a nearly silent setting. Choice B is incorrect because this quotation emphasizes the size of the book Valia is reading, not a quality of the setting where he’s reading it. Choice C is incorrect because this quotation describes Valia approaching a window and looking at toys, not reading in a quiet setting.

Q7

D

D. increase the number of new or inexperienced cyclists riding in the city.

Choice D is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of the relationship between street lighting and people's cycling behavior. According to the text, Eugeni Vidal-Tortosa and Robin Lovelace found that poor street lighting deters new or inexperienced cyclists from riding their bikes in a city but has little effect on experienced cyclists. This finding establishes a causal relationship between street lighting and the willingness of new or inexperienced cyclists to ride a bicycle in the city: if poor lighting discourages new or inexperienced cyclists from riding, then improving lighting conditions by increasing the number of streetlights would logically remove this deterrent, potentially leading to an increase in the number of new or inexperienced cyclists willing to ride in the city.

Choice A is incorrect because it contradicts the logical relationship established in the text. If poor street lighting deters new or inexperienced cyclists from riding in the city, then increasing the number of streetlights (improving lighting conditions) would be expected to encourage more of these cyclists to ride, not decrease their numbers. Choice B is incorrect because the text explicitly states that street lighting didn't have an effect on experienced cyclists. If lighting conditions don't significantly influence experienced cyclists' decisions to ride, then increasing the number of streetlights wouldn't necessarily increase the number of experienced cyclists riding in the city. Choice C is incorrect. The text indicates that street lighting didn't affect experienced cyclists, so increasing the number of streetlights wouldn't decrease the participation of these cyclists. Instead, their numbers would be expected to remain about the same.

Q8

D

D. Ecologists predict that corals store large amounts of microplastics from ocean waters.

Choice D is the best answer. The text describes a study about how reef-building corals capture microplastics from ocean waters, which found that these corals are storing 20 million kilograms of microplastics in their skeletons and tissues.

Choice A is incorrect. While the researchers are studying “reef-building corals,” the focus of their study isn’t how the corals build the reefs. Rather, they’re studying how corals may be storing microplastics from ocean waters. Choice B is incorrect. The text doesn’t mention any unanswered questions about the impact of corals on ocean ecosystems—rather, the study assesses one interaction between corals and microplastics. Choice C is incorrect. The text does say this, but it’s a detail—not the main idea. The main idea of the text is about the study that found that corals may be storing microplastics from ocean waters in their skeletons and tissues.

Q9

B

B. Montréal

Choice B is the best answer because the graph shows that Montréal had the largest population in 1891 among the four cities represented. According to the data points in the graph for the year 1891, Montréal’s population was approximately 220,000, which is greater than the respective populations of Toronto (approximately 180,000), Québec City (approximately 60,000), and Halifax (approximately 40,000).

Choice A is incorrect because Toronto’s population in 1891 was approximately 180,000, which is the second largest among the four cities shown but still clearly smaller than Montréal’s population of approximately 220,000. Choice C is incorrect because Québec City had a population of approximately 60,000 in 1891, making it only the third largest of the four cities shown. Choice D is incorrect because Halifax had a population of approximately 40,000 people in 1891. Of the four cities shown in the graph, Halifax has the smallest population, not the largest.

Q10

A

A. had an important role in Egypt's government.

Choice A is the best answer because it most logically completes the text's discussion of the evidence found in Queen Merneith's tomb. The text begins by mentioning archaeologists' efforts to excavate the tomb of Queen Merneith, the wife of a pharaoh who some scholars think was actually the first female pharaoh. The text states that a tablet discovered in her tomb suggests she "was in charge of the country's treasury and other central offices," which supports the idea that she had an important role in Egypt's government.

Choice B is incorrect because since the text explicitly states that Merneith's husband was a First Dynasty pharaoh, it can be inferred that she lived during the First Dynasty, not after it. Choice C is incorrect because the text does not provide any evidence that Merneith traveled beyond Egypt's borders often. The text is focused on the archaeological discovery in her tomb and the implications about her potential role as a ruler in Egypt but does not mention anything about her traveling habits. Choice D is incorrect because the text does not mention anything about Merneith creating a new form of writing in Egypt. The text discusses the discovery of a tablet with writing suggesting her governmental role but does not imply that this writing represented a new form created by Merneith.

Notes

Accept equivalent forms (e.g. $0.25 \equiv 1/4$). For grid-in items, decimal and fraction answers are both valid.

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